

Vinay Degavath

Head of Product | DeFi · CeFi · Protocol Design

IIT Kharagpur | Token 2049 Speaker

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SUMMARY

Product leader, 13+ years DeFi/fintech. Founded Hashstack — under-collateralized lending on Starknet with autonomous smart-contract risk (no credit committees). Head of Product at Finin (employee #2; neobank acquired by Open). Authored proposed EIP-5299.

EXPERIENCE

Hashstack Finance

2020 – 2026

Founder & CEO — hashstack.finance

Bengaluru

- Designed autonomous risk framework for under-collateralized lending — zero credit committee; solvency via smart-contract constraints only
- Shipped Degen Mode — one-click leveraged execution that abstracted borrow/swap/LP while locking borrowed capital to on-protocol deployment
- Built DIAL (v1) for term-deposit lending; learned complexity and audit cost weren't justified vs a simpler model — production IRM (v2) = kinked utilization curve for auditability and determinism
- Led product across eng, community, and BD (16-person team). Deprioritized CEX listing to prioritize protocol security — CertiK audit
- Raised \$1M seed + additional private funding; 36,000 on-chain users at \$55/user and \$56K+ first-year revenue (*operator metrics*); 61% average utilization (*operator metric*). Launched HSTK on Uniswap (Ethereum) + Ekubo (Starknet); 180K STRK + \$50K Harmony grants
- Orchestrated 7 protocol integrations (Aave, Chainlink, Herodotus, ZKLend, Myswap, Jediswap, Chainstack). Authored EIP-5299 — proposed Layer3 scaling EIP
- Led structured wind-down after Starknet adoption lagged and Cairo 2.0 migration ROI turned negative; Base testnet validated EVM portability

Finin

Oct 2019 – Jul 2020

Head of Product — acquired by Open Financial Technologies

Bengaluru

- Employee #2; grew engineering 0→16 through product-market fit
- Designed and shipped neobank core banking (KYC → savings → cards) with State Bank of Mauritius as banking partner; product scope shaped by RBI digital-banking constraints
- Acquired 5,000 savings accounts via product-led growth (*operator metric*)
- Company acquired by Open — validated PMF (TechCrunch)

Guardrail

2016 – Present

Managing Partner — guardrail.fund

- Conviction-driven single-family office; 10+ year horizon across digital assets, metals, real estate, frontier tech
- Sourced deal flow; market theses for early-stage digital assets (2017–2019). Angel investor in Gushwork (\$9M seed)

Earlier Experience

Echo · Qulp · AIESEC

- **Echo** (Co-founder, 2016–2017) — Location-based social discovery. Facebook FBSTART. SURGE 2016. 3,000 users. #13 India Play Store, zero marketing spend
- **Qulp** (Founder, 2013–2015) — Hardware innovation platform. Google Launchpad 2014. TiE Asia regional finalists 2014. \$60K in pre-orders. Team of 7
- **AIESEC IIT Kharagpur** (VP Marketing & PR, 2010–2013) — Led 13-person team across promotions, branding, and media. 1st place, Nokia-AIESEC India campaign

PUBLISHED WORK & SPEAKING

EIP-5299: Layer3 Scaling Standard — [discussion](#)

Open Protocol Whitepaper

DIAL: Dynamic Interest Algorithm (v1) — Interest Rate Model (v2)

Speaker, Token 2049 (2022)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Solidity, Cairo, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL

Protocols: Starknet, Ethereum, L2/ZK Architecture

Tools: Dune Analytics, Jira/Linear, Notion, Amplitude, Figma, GitHub

CORE COMPETENCIES

Protocol Design · Token Economics · DeFi Mechanics · Product Strategy · 0→1 Product Building · Team Leadership ·
Cross-chain Architecture · L2/ZK · Risk Framework Design · Go-to-Market

EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur